
Domain V — Performing Internal Audit Services

Internal audit services include assurance, advice, or a combination of both. The Standards apply to these services unless an individual standard specifies otherwise.

Performing an engagement involves planning, conducting work, developing findings and conclusions, collaborating with management on recommendations or action plans, communicating results, and following up.

These activities can overlap. Information identified during testing may require auditors to revisit the risk assessment, objectives, scope, or work program.

Service	Purpose	Key consideration
Assurance	Provide an objective assessment of governance, risk management, and controls against evaluation criteria	Conclusions should reflect evidence, coverage, and relevant limitations
Advisory	Provide advice, insight, training, facilitation, or other agreed assistance	Auditors must maintain objectivity and avoid assuming management responsibility

The CAE establishes the methodologies used to deliver internal audit services. Appropriate responsibilities may be delegated to qualified professionals, while ultimate accountability remains with the CAE.

Principle 13 — Plan Engagements Effectively

Internal auditors plan each engagement using a systematic and disciplined approach. Planning connects the reason for the engagement with relevant risks, objectives, scope, evaluation criteria, resources, and specific procedures.

Standard	Title	Main focus
13.1	Engagement Communication	Communication throughout the engagement
13.2	Engagement Risk Assessment	Understanding the activity and prioritizing relevant risks
13.3	Engagement Objectives and Scope	Defining the purpose and boundaries of the work
13.4	Evaluation Criteria	Establishing suitable benchmarks for evaluation
13.5	Engagement Resources	Identifying appropriate and sufficient resources

Standard	Title	Main focus
13.6	Work Program	Translating planning into documented tasks and testing methods

Standard 13.1 — Engagement Communication

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must communicate effectively throughout the engagement.

They must communicate the engagement's objectives, scope, and timing with management, and communicate subsequent changes in a timely manner.

When internal auditors and management disagree about engagement results at the end of the engagement:

- Internal auditors must discuss the issue and attempt to reach a mutual understanding with management of the activity under review.
- Auditors must not be obligated to change results without a valid reason.
- An established methodology must allow both parties to express their positions and explain differences concerning the final engagement communication.

Considerations for Implementation

Communication may include initial, ongoing, closing, and final communications. Methods can include meetings, presentations, emails, written documents, and informal discussions.

Useful communication topics include:

- The reason for the engagement and its proposed timing.
- Risk assessment results, objectives, and scope.
- Information and resources required.
- Arrangements for progress updates and final reporting.
- Issues requiring immediate attention.
- Changes to objectives, scope, timing, or duration.
- Findings, recommendations, and management's proposed actions.
- Action owners and implementation dates.

Advance notice should follow the CAE's policy on timing and type of notification. An opening meeting can clarify expectations and confirm management's understanding of the planned work.

A closing discussion can address factual accuracy, disagreements, and the feasibility of proposed actions. Management may finalize its action plans after this discussion.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Emails, meeting minutes, notes, or memoranda demonstrating communication throughout the engagement.
- Records of feedback from management of the activity under review.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Communication of objectives, scope, and timing.
- Management's understanding of the engagement.
- Ongoing updates and urgent-issue communication.
- Timely notification of changes.
- Documentation and resolution of disagreements.
- Clear ownership and timing of management actions.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Objectives and scope are not clearly communicated	Misunderstanding, resistance, or unmet expectations
Required information is requested late	Fieldwork delays and incomplete testing
Significant issues are held until final reporting	Management loses the opportunity to act promptly
Scope or timing changes are not communicated	Stakeholders work with outdated expectations
Disagreements are resolved through unsupported changes	Findings and conclusions lose objectivity
Action responsibilities remain unclear	Corrective actions are delayed or not implemented

4. Controls — Suggested

Control	Type
Use an engagement communication plan identifying recipients, topics, and timing	Preventive
Document opening discussions and initial information requests	Preventive
Maintain progress updates and a process for urgent issues	Detective / Corrective
Record and communicate significant planning changes	Preventive / Corrective
Maintain a disagreement log recording evidence, positions, and resolution	Detective

Control	Type
Confirm management action owners and target dates	Preventive

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Procedure	Required evidence
Verify communication of objectives, scope, and timing	Engagement announcement, opening meeting records
Assess whether updates reflected engagement progress and emerging issues	Status reports, correspondence, meeting notes
Trace significant changes to timely management communication	Change log, notifications, revised planning documents
Review how urgent matters were communicated	Issue records, escalation correspondence
Examine disagreements and the reasons for any changes to results	Drafts, supporting evidence, management responses
Confirm communication of proposed actions, ownership, and timing	Closing meeting records, action plans

6. Red Flags

- Management first learns about a major issue in the final report.
- Fieldwork begins without clear communication of scope.
- Changes are communicated informally but not documented.
- Findings are removed solely because management objects.
- Important disagreements have no recorded rationale or resolution.
- Action plans have no identifiable owner or completion date.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Engagement objectives and timing were not communicated to relevant management.
- Significant scope changes were not reflected in stakeholder updates.
- Urgent control concerns were held until final reporting.
- Changes to findings lacked supporting evidence or a documented valid reason.
- The engagement file did not demonstrate how differing positions were addressed.

8. Professional References

- Standard 13.1 — Engagement Communication.
- Principle 11 — Communicate Effectively.
- Standard 9.3 — Methodologies.
- Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
- Standard 14.4 — Recommendations and Action Plans.
- Standard 15.1 — Final Engagement Communication.

Standard 13.2 — Engagement Risk Assessment

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must understand the activity under review sufficiently to assess relevant risks.

For advisory services, a formal documented risk assessment may not be necessary, depending on the agreement with relevant stakeholders.

Auditors must gather reliable, relevant, and sufficient information concerning:

- Organizational strategies, objectives, and risks relevant to the activity.
- Risk tolerance, if established.
- The risk assessment supporting the internal audit plan.
- The activity's governance, risk management, and control processes.
- Applicable frameworks, guidance, and evaluation criteria.

Auditors must review this information to understand how processes are intended to operate.

They must identify potentially significant risks to the activity's objectives, consider specific fraud risks, evaluate risk significance, and prioritize risks for review.

They must also identify the criteria management uses to measure achievement of the activity's objectives.

Where relevant risks were identified in previous engagements, auditors are required to review and update the previous engagement risk assessment.

Considerations for Implementation

- Understand why the engagement was included in the audit plan.
- Consider changes since the organizationwide risk assessment and audit planning process.
- Review prior engagements, management risk assessments, and relevant work by other assurance providers.
- Gather information through interviews, observation, walkthroughs, document review, inspections, and system or data analysis.
- Connect the activity's objectives to risks and the controls intended to manage them.
- Assess significance using professional judgment, considering likelihood, impact, and other relevant factors.
- Consider management's input while retaining independent judgment.
- Evaluate control design for significant risks to inform further testing.
- Update the risk and control analysis as new information emerges.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Documented organizational and activity objectives.
- Process descriptions, policies, organizational charts, and job descriptions.
- Interview, walkthrough, inspection, and observation records.
- Relevant system information and data.
- Previous risk assessments and assurance reports.
- Analysis of risk significance and control design adequacy.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Understanding of business objectives and processes.
- Reliability and completeness of planning information.
- Consideration of changes and emerging risks.
- Specific assessment of fraud risks.
- Risk prioritization and supporting rationale.
- Linkage between objectives, risks, controls, and planned work.
- Review and update of prior assessments.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Planning relies on outdated information	Significant current risks are excluded
Risks are disconnected from business objectives	Audit effort focuses on low-value issues
Fraud risks are not specifically considered	Relevant fraud scenarios and control weaknesses are overlooked
Management's assessment is accepted without challenge	Understated or omitted risks remain unidentified
Control existence is confused with effective design	Testing provides insufficient assurance
Risk significance is unsupported	Engagement priorities cannot be justified

4. Controls — Suggested

Control	Type
Use a structured information-gathering and risk assessment methodology	Preventive
Document changes since the previous assessment	Detective
Include an explicit fraud-risk assessment step	Preventive
Maintain an objective-risk-control matrix	Preventive / Detective
Require supervisory review of risk significance and prioritization	Detective
Update the assessment when fieldwork reveals relevant new information	Corrective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Procedure	Required evidence
Trace identified risks to activity and organizational objectives	Strategy documents, objectives, risk assessment
Assess whether information sources were sufficiently reliable and current	Source records, data validation, interviews
Verify consideration of changes since prior planning	Change analysis, prior assessments, recent developments
Examine the assessment of specific fraud scenarios	Fraud-risk analysis, discussion records, planned responses
Reassess selected risk ratings and prioritization decisions	Rating methodology, rationale, supporting evidence
Review whether significant risks were connected to controls and planned testing	Risk and control matrix, work program
Verify that reused assessments were reviewed and updated	Prior and current versions, review records

6. Red Flags

- The risk assessment is copied from the previous engagement without updates.
- Every risk has the same rating without explanation.
- Fraud is mentioned only as a generic sentence.
- Process understanding relies entirely on policies without checking actual practices.
- Significant system or organizational changes are absent from planning.
- Risks identified during fieldwork are not reflected in the assessment.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- The engagement risk assessment did not address significant changes in the activity.
- Specific fraud risks were not evaluated.
- Risk prioritization lacked supporting rationale.
- Significant objectives were not linked to assessed risks.
- The previous assessment was reused without documented review or updating.
- Control design weaknesses identified during planning did not inform the work program.

8. Professional References

- Standard 13.2 — Engagement Risk Assessment.
 - Standard 14.6 — Engagement Documentation.
 - Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
 - Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
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Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must establish and document objectives and scope for every engagement.

Objectives must explain the engagement's purpose and specific goals, including goals mandated by laws or regulations.

Scope must define the engagement's focus and boundaries, including relevant activities, locations, processes, systems, components, and time period. It must be sufficient to achieve the objectives.

Auditors must consider whether the engagement provides assurance or advisory services because expectations and applicable requirements can differ.

For assurance engagements, scope limitations may include resource constraints or restrictions on access to personnel, facilities, data, or information that prevent the expected work.

- Identified scope limitations must be discussed with management to seek resolution.
- If unresolved, the CAE must elevate the issue to the board according to an established methodology.
- Auditors must have flexibility to change objectives and scope as the engagement progresses.
- The CAE must approve objectives, scope, and subsequent changes.

Considerations for Implementation

- Align engagement objectives with relevant business and organizational objectives.
- Use the engagement risk assessment to focus the work.
- Assess each objective separately to confirm the scope can support it.
- Define boundaries clearly enough to guide testing, timing, and resource allocation.
- Consider whether stakeholder requests to exclude areas or restrict duration create a scope limitation.
- Assurance objectives and scope are primarily determined by internal auditors.
- Advisory objectives and scope are typically developed jointly with the management requesting or receiving the service.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Engagement planning memorandum.
- Documented alignment between objectives and assessed risks.
- Approved work program containing objectives and scope.
- Stakeholder meeting records.

- Scope limitation records and inclusion or exclusion requests.
- Final engagement communication.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Clarity and specificity of engagement objectives.
- Scope sufficiency for each objective.
- Alignment with significant risks.
- Identification of service type.
- CAE approval and change control.
- Identification, discussion, and escalation of limitations.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Objectives are vague	Procedures and conclusions lack a clear purpose
Scope is too narrow	Significant risks remain unexamined
Scope expands without control	Resources are diverted and completion is delayed
Restrictions are not recognized as limitations	Stakeholders receive unjustified assurance
Changes are not approved	Work diverges from authorized objectives
Unresolved limitations are not escalated	The board is unaware of constraints on assurance

4. Controls — Suggested

Control	Type
Document objectives and detailed scope boundaries in a planning memorandum	Preventive
Map each objective to risks and planned coverage	Preventive / Detective
Require CAE approval of objectives, scope, and changes	Preventive
Maintain a scope change and limitation register	Detective
Apply a documented process for resolving and escalating limitations	Corrective
Reassess the implications of limitations for reporting and conclusions	Detective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Procedure	Required evidence
Assess whether objectives identify specific goals	Planning memorandum, engagement rationale
Compare each objective with planned scope and procedures	Scope statement, risk assessment, work program

Procedure	Required evidence
Verify CAE approval of initial and revised objectives and scope	Approval records, version history
Review requests to exclude activities or restrict time and access	Correspondence, limitation register
Trace unresolved limitations through management discussion and board escalation	Minutes, escalation papers, CAE records
Compare performed work and reported conclusions with the approved boundaries	Workpapers, final communication

6. Red Flags

- The objective is simply “review the department.”
- The scope omits a significant system supporting the stated objective.
- Management excludes a high-risk area without documented evaluation.
- Access restrictions are treated only as delays.
- Engagement boundaries change without CAE approval.
- Conclusions imply broader coverage than the work performed.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Scope boundaries did not specify the period or systems reviewed.
- Planned coverage was insufficient for a stated objective.
- Significant scope changes lacked documented CAE approval.
- Unresolved access restrictions were not elevated to the board.
- The engagement team did not assess whether stakeholder exclusions created a limitation.

8. Professional References

- Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
 - Standard 13.2 — Engagement Risk Assessment.
 - Standard 13.5 — Engagement Resources.
 - Standard 13.1 — Engagement Communication.
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Standard 13.4 — Evaluation Criteria

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must identify the most relevant criteria for evaluating the matters defined by the engagement objectives and scope.

For advisory services, identifying evaluation criteria may not be necessary, depending on the agreement with relevant stakeholders.

Auditors must assess whether the board and senior management have established adequate criteria for determining whether the activity achieves its objectives and goals.

- If the criteria are adequate, auditors must use them.
- If inadequate, auditors must identify appropriate criteria through discussion with the board and/or senior management.

Considerations for Implementation

Criteria describe the expected or desired state. Auditors compare these criteria with the actual condition to identify potential findings and support conclusions.

Adequate criteria should be relevant, aligned with objectives, specific, practical, and capable of producing reliable comparisons.

Potential sources include:

Source	Examples
Internal requirements	Policies, procedures, performance indicators, targets
External obligations	Laws, regulations, contracts
Authoritative practices	Relevant standards, frameworks, guidance, benchmarks
Established practices	Consistently applied organizational procedures
Control design	Expected control outcomes and operating requirements

Auditors should consider risk tolerance, materiality thresholds, and the organization's definition of satisfactory control performance.

Where criteria lack detail, auditors may assist management or seek expert input. The absence of adequate criteria may also lead to consideration of advisory services.

Criteria should be communicated to management and documented to reduce misunderstanding and later disputes.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Sources of criteria considered.
- Documented assessment of criteria adequacy.
- Meeting minutes, planning memoranda, or correspondence concerning criteria discussions.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Relevance of criteria to each objective.
- Adequacy of management's criteria.
- Applicability of external requirements.
- Consistency and measurability of benchmarks.
- Discussion of inadequate or missing criteria.
- Documentation and communication of the selected criteria.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Criteria are absent or vague	Findings and conclusions become subjective
Inadequate management criteria are accepted	Weak performance may be assessed as satisfactory
Criteria are unrelated to objectives	Testing does not answer the engagement questions
Outdated or inapplicable requirements are used	Findings are inaccurate or disputed
Criteria change without justification	Evaluation becomes inconsistent
Good practice is presented as a mandatory obligation	Report users misunderstand the basis of a finding

4. Controls — Suggested

Control	Type
Maintain a criteria register linked to engagement objectives	Preventive
Document source, applicability, version, and effective period	Preventive
Assess criteria adequacy before applying them	Detective
Record discussions with the board and/or senior management where criteria are inadequate	Preventive / Corrective
Communicate selected criteria to activity management	Preventive
Review findings for consistency with the documented criteria	Detective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Procedure	Required evidence
Map criteria to engagement objectives and scope	Criteria register, planning memorandum
Assess whether criteria permit meaningful and reliable comparison	Definitions, targets, adequacy assessment
Confirm applicability and currency of selected requirements	Source documents, effective dates, applicability analysis
Review handling of inadequate or missing criteria	Discussion records, alternative criteria, expert input
Verify communication of criteria to management	Emails, minutes, planning documents
Trace sampled findings to the selected criteria and actual condition	Findings, workpapers, source requirements

6. Red Flags

- Findings use phrases such as “not adequate” without a benchmark.
- Criteria are selected after testing solely to justify a finding.
- Obsolete policies are used without considering the audited period.
- Informal preferences are described as mandatory requirements.
- Identical conditions are evaluated against different unexplained thresholds.
- Management is unaware of the criteria used.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- The engagement file did not explain how criteria adequacy was assessed.
- Selected criteria did not address a significant engagement objective.
- Inadequate management criteria were used without the required discussion.
- The source or applicability of a benchmark was not documented.
- Findings did not clearly distinguish mandatory obligations from improvement opportunities.

8. Professional References

- Standard 13.4 — Evaluation Criteria.
 - Standard 13.2 — Engagement Risk Assessment.
 - Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
 - Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
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Standard 13.5 — Engagement Resources

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

During planning, internal auditors must identify the types and quantity of resources needed to achieve the engagement objectives.

They must consider:

- The engagement's nature and complexity.
- The required completion time frame.
- Whether available financial, human, and technological resources are appropriate and sufficient.

If resources are inappropriate or insufficient, auditors must discuss the concern with the CAE to obtain the needed resources.

Considerations for Implementation

- Use the planned tasks and expected time requirements to determine staffing and other resource needs.
- Match specialist competencies to the work, including technical or industry knowledge.
- Consider budgeted hours, scheduling, logistics, language needs, and technology availability.
- Assess both suitability and quantity: sufficient staff numbers do not compensate for missing expertise.
- Escalate constraints that interfere with achieving objectives.
- The CAE considers the implications with senior management and the board and determines an appropriate course of action.
- Where scope changes are necessary, apply the approval and limitation requirements of Standard 13.3.
- Compare actual time with budgeted time to improve future planning.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Approved work program showing resource utilization.
- Analysis of resource needs and assignments.
- Post-engagement feedback about timing and resource adequacy.
- Contracts or arrangements with external service providers.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Linkage between resource estimates and planned procedures.
- Adequacy of engagement competencies.

- Availability of time, funding, and technology.
- Specialist support and supervision.
- Escalation of resource gaps.
- Learning from actual versus planned resource use.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Staff lack the necessary expertise	Significant issues are missed or misunderstood
Time budgets are unrealistic	Testing is rushed or incomplete
Technology is unavailable or unsuitable	Data analysis and evidence gathering are restricted
Resource gaps are not escalated	Objectives remain formally unchanged but cannot be achieved
Scope is reduced without assessing implications	Significant risks receive insufficient coverage
Recurring overruns are not analyzed	Planning weaknesses continue

4. Controls — Suggested

Control	Type
Prepare task-based estimates of time, competencies, funding, and technology	Preventive
Match staff competencies to assigned procedures	Preventive
Arrange specialist support when needed	Preventive
Escalate resource deficiencies to the CAE with their expected impact	Corrective
Monitor resource use and remaining work during the engagement	Detective
Analyze significant variances after completion	Detective / Corrective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Procedure	Required evidence
Compare estimated resources with engagement complexity and planned tasks	Work program, resource plan, time estimates
Assess whether assigned auditors have relevant competencies	Skills matrix, experience records, assignments
Verify availability of required tools and specialist support	Access records, contracts, staffing schedules
Review identified deficiencies and CAE discussions	Resource gap analysis, correspondence, decisions

Procedure	Required evidence
Assess whether resource-driven scope changes were appropriately handled	Revised scope, approvals, limitation records
Compare actual resource use with budget and examine significant variances	Time records, cost reports, lessons learned

6. Red Flags

- Specialist testing is assigned without relevant expertise or support.
- Every engagement receives the same time allocation regardless of complexity.
- Procedures are omitted because the budget is exhausted.
- Resource gaps are known but not discussed with the CAE.
- Required data tools become available only near engagement completion.
- Repeated overruns result in no changes to planning assumptions.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Resource estimates were not linked to the planned work.
- The engagement team lacked a competency needed for a significant objective.
- Insufficient resources were not escalated to the CAE.
- Resource-driven scope reductions were not evaluated or approved appropriately.
- Actual-versus-budget variances were not used to improve future planning.

8. Professional References

- Standard 13.5 — Engagement Resources.
- Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
- Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
- Principle 10 — Manage Resources.

Standard 13.6 — Work Program

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must develop and document a work program designed to achieve the engagement objectives.

The program must be based on planning information, including the engagement risk assessment where applicable.

It must identify:

1. Criteria for evaluating each objective.
2. Tasks needed to achieve the objectives.
3. Methodologies, including analytical procedures and tools.
4. Internal auditors assigned to each task.

The CAE must review and approve the work program **before implementation** and promptly when subsequent changes are made.

Considerations for Implementation

- Translate planning information into specific procedures for gathering, analyzing, and evaluating evidence.
- Reference supporting planning workpapers.
- For advisory engagements, develop the program in collaboration with the requesting stakeholders.
- Link risks and controls to testing procedures, and subsequently to findings and conclusions.
- Record who completed each task, completion dates, and evidence of review and approval.
- When sampling is used, document the methodology, population, sample size, and whether results can be projected to the population.
- Document the assessment of control design in the program or a separate workpaper.
- Control design assessment may occur during planning, as a separate execution stage, or alongside operating-effectiveness testing, depending on the engagement.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Risk and control matrix with testing approach.
- Process maps and control descriptions.
- Control design evaluation records.
- Plans for additional testing.
- Planning meeting records.
- Complete approved work program.
- Documented approval of changes.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Coverage of every engagement objective.
- Linkage to assessed risks and relevant controls.
- Specificity of tasks and testing methods.
- Identification of evaluation criteria.
- Assignment of responsibility.
- Sampling design and justified interpretation.
- Initial approval, change approval, and completion records.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
A generic program is used without adaptation	Significant engagement-specific risks are missed
Tasks do not cover all objectives	Conclusions lack sufficient support
Procedures are vague	Auditors perform inconsistent or ineffective testing
Sampling decisions are unsupported	Results are misinterpreted or improperly generalized
Work begins before program approval	Inappropriate procedures proceed without review
Changes are not controlled	Important coverage is removed or added without adequate oversight

4. Controls — Suggested

Control	Type
Map objectives, risks, controls, criteria, and procedures	Preventive / Detective
Require specific testing instructions and evidence expectations	Preventive
Assign an auditor to each task	Preventive
Obtain CAE review and approval before implementation	Preventive
Maintain version history and approval of changes	Preventive / Detective
Document sampling design and limits on projection	Preventive
Track completion, workpaper references, and supervisory review	Detective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Procedure	Required evidence
Trace each objective to relevant tasks and criteria	Objectives, criteria register, work program
Compare significant risks and controls with planned testing	Risk assessment, control matrix, procedures
Assess whether procedures specify useful methods and tools	Testing instructions, analytical plans
Confirm task assignments and completion records	Assignment fields, dates, workpaper references
Verify approval before implementation	Approval timestamps, fieldwork start records
Review changes for rationale and prompt approval	Version history, change log, approvals
Assess sampling methodology and any projection of results	Population records, selection method, sample rationale

Procedure	Required evidence
Verify that control design evaluation is documented	Design assessment, testing workpapers

6. Red Flags

- Procedures say only “check compliance” or “review controls.”
- Significant risks have no corresponding procedure.
- The same program is reused without considering changed objectives.
- Tasks have no assigned auditor.
- Approval is dated after substantial fieldwork.
- Sample sizes have no rationale.
- Sample results are generalized beyond what the method supports.
- Tasks are marked complete without supporting workpapers.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- The work program did not identify criteria for evaluating selected objectives.
- Procedures did not address a significant risk identified during planning.
- Implementation began before CAE approval.
- Subsequent changes lacked documented approval.
- Sampling documentation did not identify the population or support projection.
- Completed tasks lacked traceable evidence or review records.

8. Professional References

- Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
 - Standard 13.2 — Engagement Risk Assessment.
 - Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
 - Standard 13.4 — Evaluation Criteria.
 - Standard 13.5 — Engagement Resources.
 - Standard 14.6 — Engagement Documentation.
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